

EDUCATION · ENDPOINT & WEB SECURITY

60,000 Student Devices, Secured in a Single Day

How Dufferin-Peel Catholic District School Board deployed the Prisma Browser® extension to enforce district-wide safe browsing, close every workaround, and cut network support tickets by 90%.

60,000Chromebooks secured
in a single day**90%**Fewer network
support tickets**<5 min**To deploy a new
counter-control**0**SSL decryption needed
to enforce policy

The Challenge

With a small network operations team supporting a district-wide fleet of student devices, DPCDSB's legacy endpoint solution was creating cascading problems across classrooms and IT alike.

1

Application performance issues

Slowdowns and disruptions bled into classrooms, interrupting instruction and student learning activities.

2

Easy student workarounds

Tech-savvy students and staff could disable or bypass the legacy proxy simply by toggling Wi-Fi settings.

3

High operational overhead

Managing a legacy solution across multiple consoles strained a lean network operations team.

The Solution

DPCDSB layered the Palo Alto Networks Prisma Browser extension on top of its existing Next-Generation Firewalls (NGFWs) to enforce safe-browsing policy across all 60,000 Chromebooks — without the complexity of SSL decryption. The extension installs automatically through centralized policy the moment a student logs in, guaranteeing enforcement and compliance district-wide with no manual rollout.

Because the control lives with the browser rather than the network path, students can no longer break enforcement by toggling Wi-Fi settings — the failure mode that defeated the district's previous tool. Consolidating web security onto the Palo Alto Networks platform also moved the network operations team from juggling multiple consoles to a single interface in Strata Cloud Manager.

“A primary requirement was implementing a security control that students could not bypass or turn off — Prisma Browser met that challenge by installing the moment a student logs in.”

The Results



60,000 devices secured — Safe-browsing policy enforced natively across every Chromebook in the district, from the moment of first login.



90% fewer support tickets — Freed the operations team to focus on critical infrastructure projects instead of firefighting endpoint issues.



Sub-5-minute response — When a principal reports a bypass or unsafe site, a counter-control ships in Strata Cloud Manager in under five minutes.



Simplified operations — One console for investigations and policy across the entire student device fleet, with no SSL decryption overhead.

Source: Palo Alto Networks customer case study — “DPCDSB Secures 60,000 Student Devices in a Single Day.”
paloaltonetworks.com/customers/dpcdsb-secures-60000-student-devices-in-a-single-day

HIGHER EDUCATION · PLATFORMIZATION

Cardiff University Secures Modern Threats with Platformization

How a leading Russell Group research university replaced four overlapping endpoint tools with one connected Palo Alto Networks platform, backed by 24/7 managed detection and response from Unit 42.

15,000+

User personas protected across campuses

4 → 1

Endpoint tools consolidated into one platform

~10 sec

Average time between attempted cyberattacks

24/7

Managed detection & response via Unit 42

The Challenge

Cardiff University was playing cybersecurity “Whac-A-Mole” — each time one issue was resolved, a new one appeared. The reactive cycle threatened curriculum continuity and put the university’s reputation as a leading research institution at risk.

1

A sprawling, diverse user base

More than 15,000 personas across students, academics, professional services, and research staff in Wales.

2

Constant phishing & social engineering

The university faced an attempted cyberattack roughly every 10 seconds, with BYOD adding further exposure.

3

Four overlapping endpoint tools

Fragmented, reactive tooling left the security team managing alerts instead of driving strategic improvements.

The Solution

Cardiff University standardized on a single, unified security architecture with Palo Alto Networks at its core, replacing four separate endpoint security products with one connected network and endpoint platform built on Cortex XDR, Cortex XSOAR, and Network Security technologies.

The architecture is augmented by 24/7 managed detection and response from Unit 42, giving the university continuous coverage without expanding headcount. AI-driven analytics and automation now handle the alert volume that once consumed the security team’s time, freeing staff to focus on proactive, strategic work — and giving the university’s board clearer executive reporting on cybersecurity risk.

“We needed to move to a mature cybersecurity model with a well-defined technology roadmap — a strategy to streamline our tool sets and move to a fully automated, proactive platform providing 24/7 cybersecurity protection.”

— Lee Evans, Assistant Director of IT Infrastructure, Cardiff University

The Results



One connected platform — Four overlapping endpoint tools consolidated into a single, AI-powered network, browser, and endpoint security architecture.



24/7 proactive coverage — Unit 42 managed detection and response extends protection around the clock across every stage of the attack lifecycle.



Less reactive alert triage — Automation absorbs routine alert volume, freeing the security team for strategic, forward-looking work.



Board-level visibility — Executive reporting from the platform gives university leadership clearer insight into cybersecurity risk and operations.

Source: Palo Alto Networks customer case study — “Cardiff University Secures Modern Threats with Platformization.”
paloaltonetworks.com/customers/cardiff-university-secures-modern-threats-with-platformization